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DISABILITY INSURANCE

WHAT IS HOLISTIC CLAIMS MANAGEMENT?

MONICA GARCIA CONSULTING LTD

HEALTH CLAIMS FORUM WEBINAR
04/JULY/2023

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Agenda

1

Scene setting

2

Connecting with customers

3

Focusing on work ability whilst acknowledging limitations

4

Take aways and questions



ABOUT

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MONICA GARCIA BSc., MSc Health Psychology. DIRECTOR

Monica is a Disability Insurance and return-to-work strategies Consultant, bringing over 17 years of clinical, vocational, research, and insurance experience, to promote and champion best practice in the UK's Protection Insurance market.

Through her work with insurers, third-party providers, and employees, Monica leads the development of evidence-based solutions, to achieve the best possible health and return-to-work outcomes.

She has extensive experience in developing and delivering training, in a wide range of topics related to best practice in the management of Disability Insurance claims.

She also has an active role in industry initiatives, speaking at conferences, panel debates, and through publications, addressing the non-technical aspects of disability insurance risk management, improving access to insurance, and the benefits of Vocational Rehabilitation. She is a Trustee of the UK's Vocational Rehabilitation Association, (VRA) and Steering Board member of the Income Protection Task Force (IPTF).



HEALTH RISK ENVIRONMENT



OUT OF WORK

2.55M

People not working due to long-term health conditions (ONS-2023).



MENTAL HEALTH

300,000

Individuals with MH conditions drop out of work every year (Thriving at Work – Stevenson/Farmer review, 2017).



STRESS/DEPRESSION/ANXIETY

51%

Main cause of work-related ill health (Health and Safety Executive, 2022)



NHS PRESSURES

7.2M

Waiting for hospital treatment – 18 week treatment target has not been met since 2016.(commonslibrary.parliament.uk/research-briefings).

INSURANCE MARKET CHALLENGES

Public perception/consumer trust

Negative press.
We don't hear the good news.
Challenge to simplify products
Delays experienced in claims outcomes.



Complex internal dynamics

Delays in decision making: UW decisions, paying valid claims (risk of fraud).

Keeping up with health risk developments in the population, (diagnostic advances, treatments).

MORE THAN FINANCIAL COVER

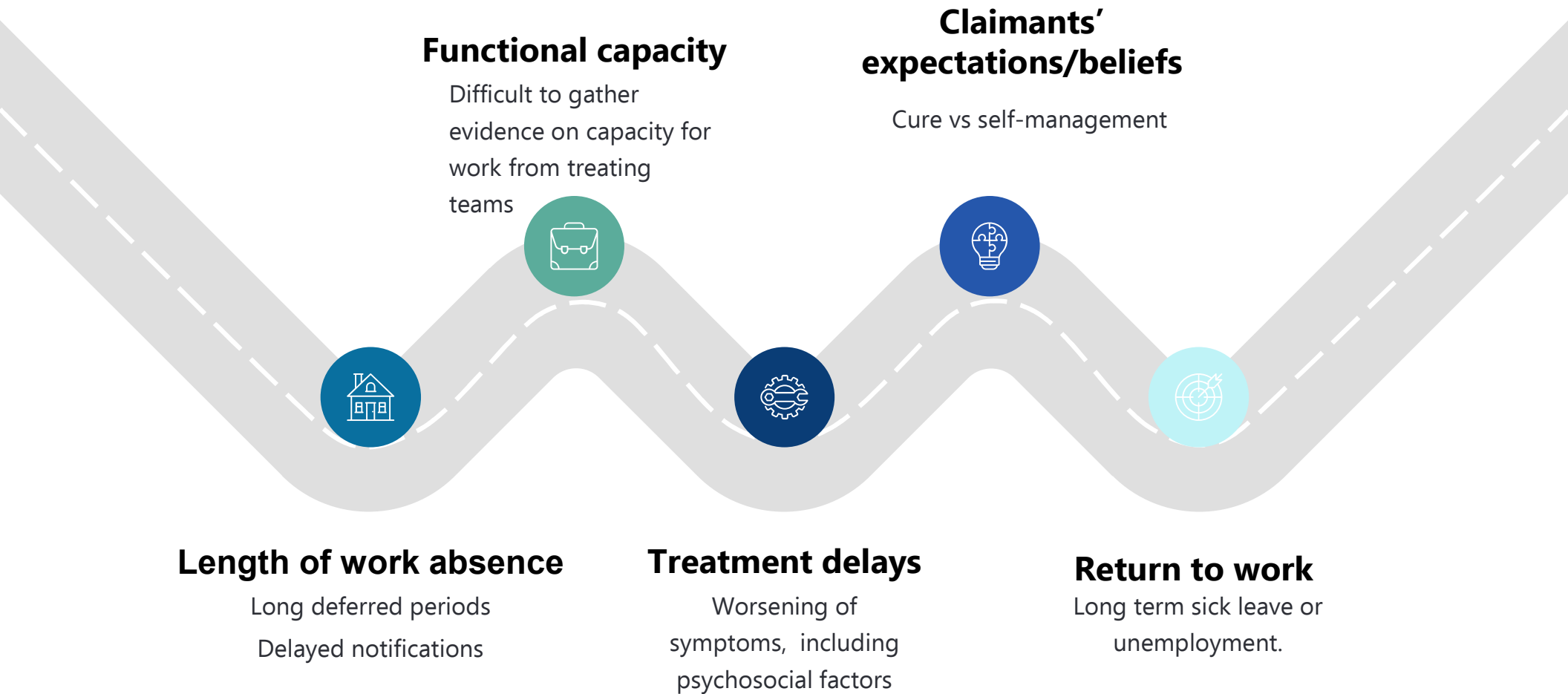
IP PRODUCT EVOLVEMENT AND ROLE OF REHABILITATION AND VOCATIONAL REHABILITATION

*Most IP insurance providers now offer some form of additional support services



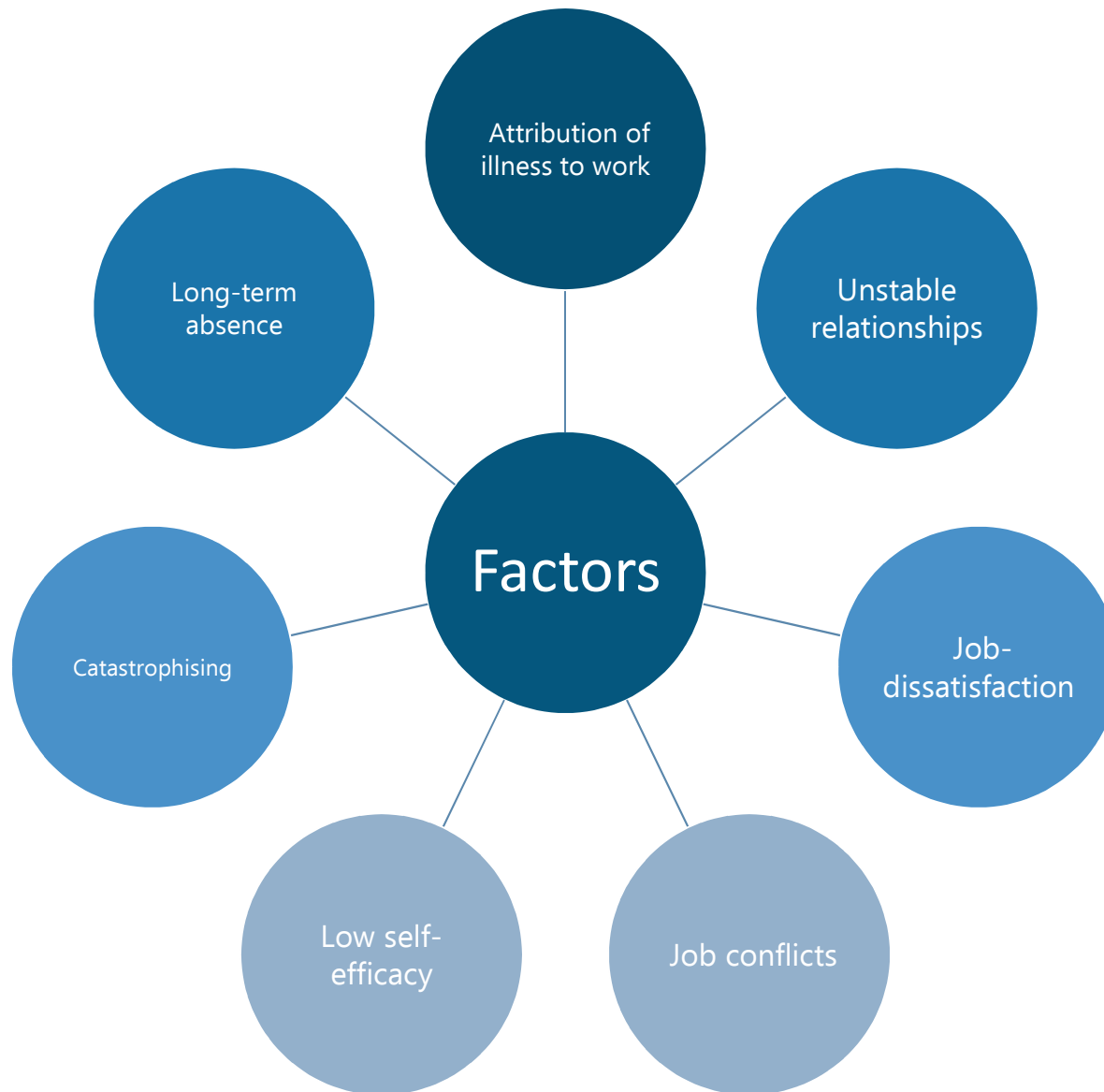
Slido: What is the most significant challenge you face when assessing and managing Disability Insurance claims?

IP CLAIMS MANAGEMENT CHALLENGES



Slido: How confident do you feel in assessing and managing Disability Insurance Claims (IP/TPD)?

LONG-TERM SICKNESS ABSENCE RISK FACTORS



EVIDENCE ON RTW PREDICTORS

*Systematic review (2018): Psychosocial factors predicting return to work

FACILITATORS	First review to systematically analyse return to work predictors after common mental disorders, cardiovascular diseases, and cancers, supporting a cross-disease approach.	BARRIERS
Job control ◀		▶ Job-strain
Work ability (self-efficacy) ◀		▶ Anxiety
Perceived good health ◀		▶ Depression
High socio-economic status ◀		▶ Co-morbidity
◀		▶ Older age and low education

* Gragnano, A, et al 2018. Common Psychosocial Factors Predicting Return to Work After Common Mental Disorders, Cardiovascular Diseases, and Cancers: A Review of Reviews Supporting a Cross-Disease Approach. *Journal of Occupational Rehabilitation*.

So.. what is Holistic Claims Management?



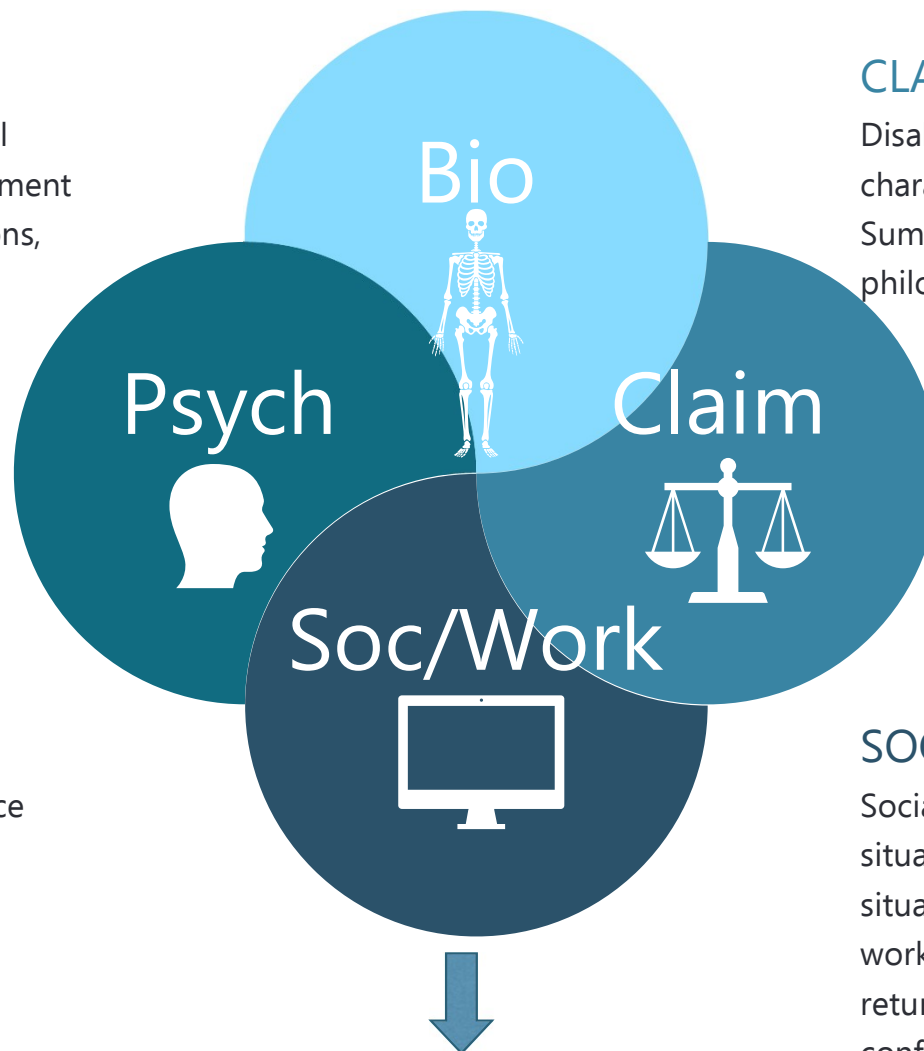
ADAPTED BIOPSYCHOSOCIAL MODEL

BIOLOGICAL

Diagnosis, pre-existing medical conditions, co-morbidity, treatment (NHS/PMI), re-current conditions, age, BMI, etc.

CLAIM

Disability Insurance product characteristics, policy definition, Ts&Cs, Sum Assured, expiry date, claims philosophy, claims tool kit.



PSYCHOLOGICAL

Coping mechanisms, confidence RTW and expectations, mental health symptoms, life goals.

SOCIAL/WORK

Social support, stressors, financial situation, lifestyle factors, work situation, work contact, return to work plan, work motivation, practical return to work considerations, work conflict, work support.

Case management plan

RTW CONVERSATIONS

Build rapport and generate trust

Early (as appropriate)

What/How

What can do?

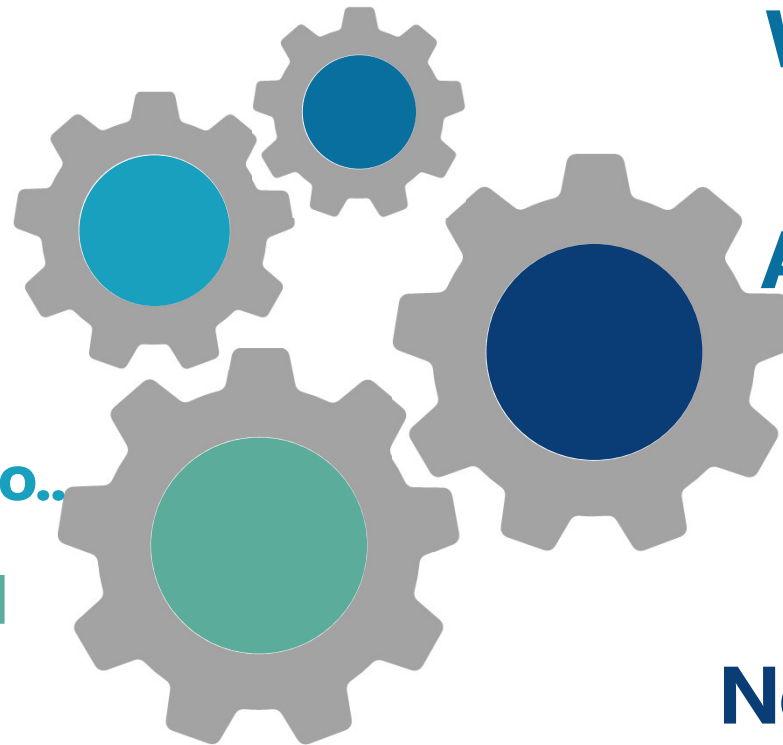
Active listening

Ideally...if you were to...

SMART goals

Any barriers? (and action plan)

Non-biased

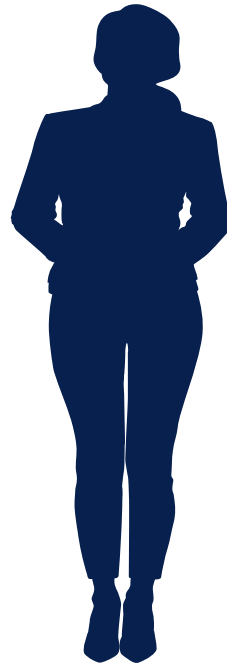


CASE STUDY

Focusing on capabilities and addressing barriers

IIP– Own Occupation

- 39yo Female
- Role: HR Consultant
- Self-employed contractor
- Sum Assured: £45.000 pa.
- Expiry date: 2044
- Anxiety (GAD diagnosis)
- Cause/Triggers: Build up of stress WFH during Covid, no life/work balance. Plus issues with neighbour who started “stalking” her family. Had Police involved.
- No PMH of MH.
- Didn’t renew last contract of Feb-21
- Tearful, has panic attacks, “freezes” and can’t open the door or deal with unexpected messages.



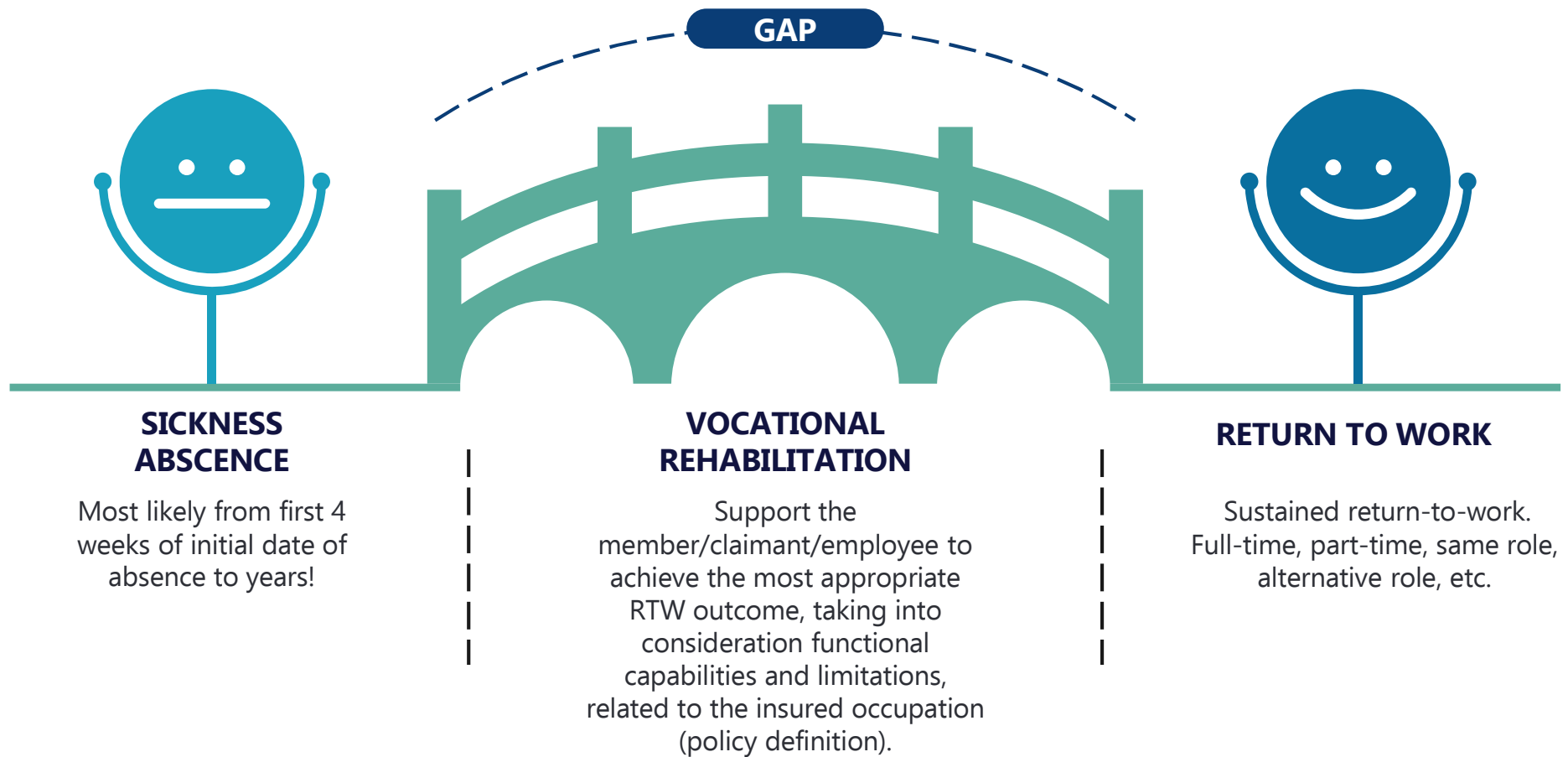
Ms Smith spent most of her time at home. She was prescribed Sertraline 150mgs, and placed on an NHS waiting list for counselling. She did not have PMI or OH support.

Senior NHS Psychologist allocated. Received 12 sessions initially, then relapsed, and received another 16 sessions.

Customer reports brain fog, finding difficult to read and “taking in information” She needs to analyse data, manage projects and confidently interact with clients. She doesn’t have a plan to RTW, she is scared about failing and “destroying her career” if she makes a mistake.

Key BPS factors? What questions would you ask.? What are the next steps of her CMx?

THE ROLE OF VOCATIONAL REHABILITATION



TOP TIPS TO ENGAGE WITH CLAIMANTS

01

Step back and have an open mind

02

Always prepare in advance

03

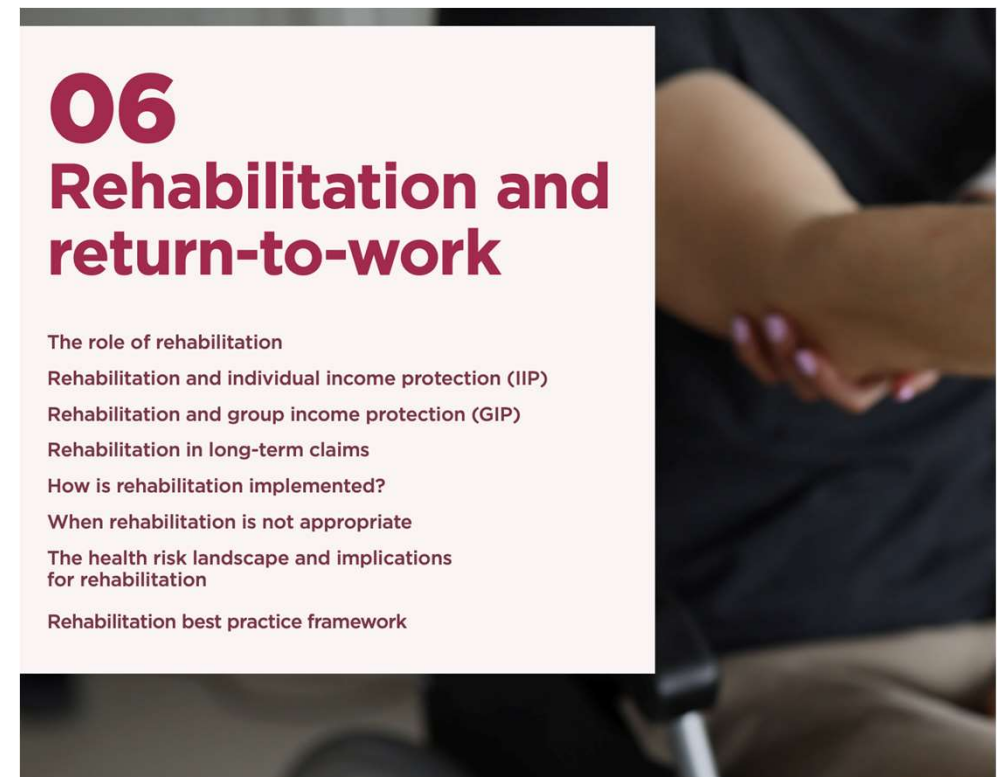
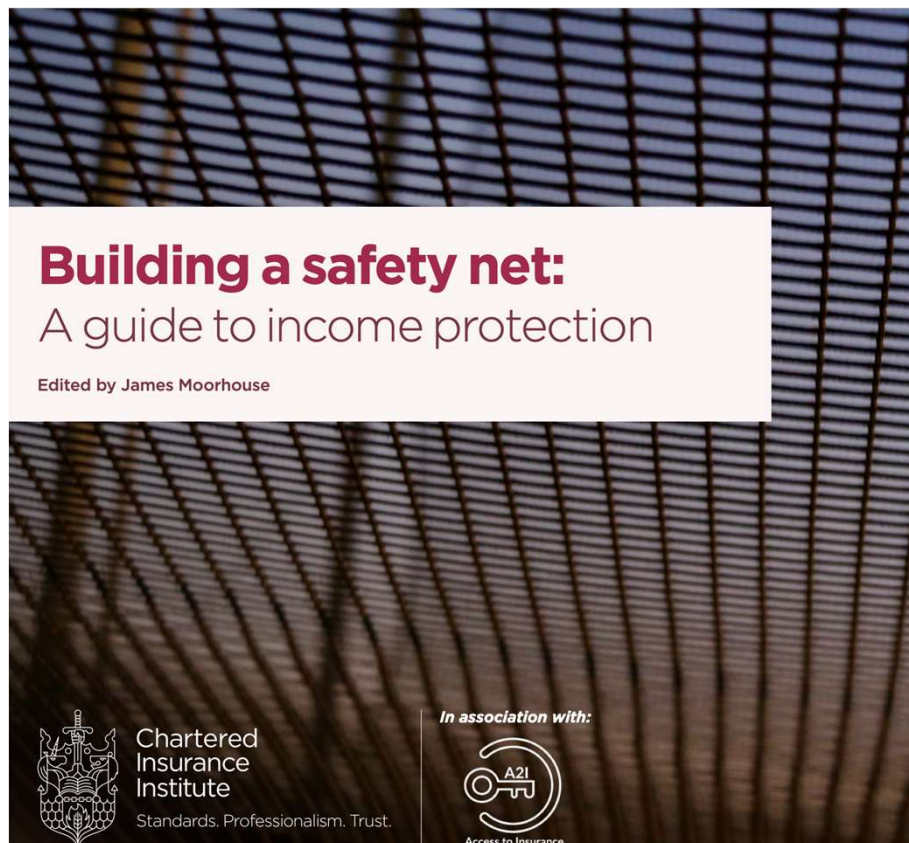
Focus on ability not disability

04

Clarify the scope of their IP/TPD cover

Further resources

MARKET OVERVIEW OF GOOD REHABILITATION PRACTICE IN IP



Source: **Building a safety net: A guide to income protection (2021)*
Chartered Insurance Institute.

EARLY INTERVENTION FOR IP



EARLY INTERVENTION

TOP 5 TIPS FOR A SUCCESSFUL IP/ EI CLAIMS STRATEGY



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Early intervention is commonly referred as any type of outcome focused rehabilitation intervention offered to IP customers within the waiting period (1)

1 ADOPT A TRUE HOLISTIC BIOPSYCHOSOCIAL APPROACH

Human behaviour is very complex, and this explains why two people with the same condition can have different IP outcomes. Some IP customers with similar conditions get better and return to work, and some others experience a longer sickness absence period (2). These are the ones likely to require additional support.

2 ENSURE THAT ANY EI PROGRAMME YOU HAVE IN PLACE IS RETURN-TO-WORK FOCUSED

And evidence- based. For many, treatment only, is not sufficient to enable a customer to make a transition back into the workplace, hence successful EI programmes have vocational rehabilitation at the core (3).

3 CLAIMS ASSESSORS PLAY A KEY ROLE IN INFLUENCING IP OUTCOMES

Building trust, having empathy and an understanding of biopsychosocial risk factors which may affect a particular case can make a huge difference. This is relevant for new and more experienced assessors.

4 MAKE SURE YOUR EI STRATEGY IS TAILORED TO YOUR IP PRODUCT

Consider your product specifications, target market, and any existing support you can tap into (PMI?)

5 TEST AND LEARN APPROACH

Monitoring what works and what doesn't is essential to make improvements. A well thought EI data gathering and analysis framework, can be aligned with your usual claim experience analysis, to identify trends and efficiencies.

WHERE CAN I FIND OUT MORE?

- info@monicagarciaconsulting.com
- monicagarciaconsulting.com



REFERENCES

1 Chartered Insurance Institute. *Building a Safety Net: A guide to Income Protection*. 2021

2 Volker D, Zijlstra-Vlasveld MC, Brouwers EP, van Lomwel AG, van der Feltz-Cornelis CM. Return-to-Work Self-Efficacy and Actual Return to Work Among Long-Term Sick-Listed Employees. *J Occup Rehabil*. 2016 Jun;25(2):423-31.

3 Waddell G, Burton AK, Kendall NAS (2008). "Vocational rehabilitation – what works, for whom, and when?"

DISABILITY CLAIMS RISK LANDSCAPE

What you'll need to navigate..



Mental health



The role of technology/AI



Ageing population/new workforce



New claims and existing claims



CLOSING THOUGHTS

What we could do better as an industry

Collaboration/Communication ●

Same goal ●

Proportional benefit ●

Promote evidence-base ●



Thank you

Any questions?



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